

Arsenal FC – Strategic Report: Preparing for the Premier League Title Challenge

Prepared for Edu Gaspar (Sporting Director) and Richard Garlick (Managing Director)

1. Executive Summary

Arsenal concluded the 2022–23 Premier League season in **second place** with 84 points, narrowly missing out on the title to Manchester City. While the season reflected progress under Mikel Arteta, recurring weaknesses — particularly in **pressure moments, goal conversion efficiency, and late-season form** — prevented Arsenal from securing the league.

This report analyzes performance data from the 2022–23 season, highlights key patterns, identifies ethical and contextual considerations, and presents tactical and strategic recommendations to strengthen Arsenal's bid for the Premier League and other trophies.

2. Objectives of This Report

- Evaluate Arsenal's 2022–23 performance using descriptive statistics and contextual insights.
 - Identify the most significant **performance gaps** (goal conversion, late-season resilience, pressure handling).
 - Provide recommendations to enhance squad depth, tactical variety, and long-term strategy.
 - Ensure ethical awareness in decision-making, acknowledging both technical and football-world biases.
-

3. Arsenal's 2022–23 Season: Key Context

- **Final Position:** 2nd place (84 points).
- **Strengths:**
 - Dominant **home performances**, strong possession play, high energy in midfield.
 - One of the youngest squads in the league, with players like Saka, Martinelli, and Ødegaard excelling.

- **Weaknesses:**
 - **Dropped 15 points in final 9 matches**, losing momentum under pressure.
 - Struggled in **crucial fixtures**, especially vs Manchester City in April.
 - **Goal conversion issues** despite high possession in many matches.
 - **Observation:** The squad needs a better balance of youth and experience to sustain performance across a full season.
-

4. Data Insights Relevant to Arsenal

From the descriptive statistics and LLM-assisted insights (Task 05, part 1 and part 2):

- **Possession:** Arsenal consistently dominated possession, particularly at home, but this did not always translate into goals in high-pressure games.
 - **Goals:** Strong scoring record overall but inconsistent in key matches.
 - **Chances:** Several matches showed high possession and chance creation but poor conversion.
 - **Critical Outlier:** The loss to Manchester City in April, despite strong build-up play, underlined the need for composure and efficiency in decisive moments.
-

5. Ethical and Bias Considerations

- **Technical Bias:** The dataset focuses only on recorded match stats. It cannot account for unmeasured factors such as injuries, referee decisions, or psychological resilience.
 - **Football-World Bias:** Arsenal faces unique **media pressure** due to expectations on Mikel Arteta in his fifth season. The young squad is also scrutinized more than experienced rivals.
 - **Ethical Awareness:** Decisions must balance **short-term fan/media expectations** with **long-term squad development**, avoiding over-reliance on youth or short-term panic signings.
-

6. Recommendations

Tactical (Short-Term)

1. Improve Goal Conversion

- Recruit at least one proven attacking player with clinical finishing ability.
- Enhance **final third decision-making** through targeted training.

2. Set Piece Optimization

- Retain Nicolas Jover but add a specialist such as **Eric Ramsey (currently at Manchester United)** to diversify attacking and defensive set-play routines.

3. Handling Pressure Matches

- Increase emphasis on high-intensity training simulations to replicate end-of-season stress conditions.

Strategic (Long-Term)

1. Squad Balance

- Blend young stars with **experienced leaders** who can manage pressure moments.
- Prioritize signings with title-winning experience.

2. Possession-Heavy Football

- Continue developing structured, possession-based play while focusing on **unlocking low blocks** in the final third.

3. Sustained Momentum

- Implement performance rotation strategies to avoid burnout in key periods of the season.

4. Holistic Development

- Invest in sports psychology to help younger players handle high-pressure environments.
-

7. Risks and Mitigation

- **Risk:** Overspending on transfers may reduce flexibility.
 - *Mitigation:* Balance marquee signings with cost-effective acquisitions.
 - **Risk:** Overreliance on possession may become predictable.
 - *Mitigation:* Train flexible tactical variations (direct play, transitions).
 - **Risk:** Media and fan expectations may create unrealistic benchmarks.
 - *Mitigation:* Transparent communication of long-term vision.
-

8. Conclusion

Arsenal's 2022–23 campaign confirmed progress but also exposed critical weaknesses in **goal conversion, pressure management, and tactical adaptability**. By **reinforcing attacking options, enhancing set-piece routines, and balancing youth with experience**, Arsenal can transform promise into trophies.

A measured combination of tactical fixes and strategic planning will allow Arsenal to sustain performance across an entire season, positioning the club to end its Premier League title drought.

9. Appendices

- **Appendix A:** [Descriptive statistics summary \(Task 05 – part 1\)](#).
- **Appendix B:** [Descriptive statistics summary \(Task 05 – part 2\)](#).
- **Appendix C:** [AI street interview highlights \(Task 06\)](#).